



The Outreach We're Not Doing

We've built a great system for *making* open calls and exhibitions — and almost no system for **promoting** them.

There's a tool we already own that fills the gap.

For Scott & Elise

Not Real Art · Artsville · Arterial

June 2026

THE PROBLEM

Three Gaps We Keep Hitting

No central repository

Press & outreach contacts live in inboxes and people's heads — not a shared, structured system.

No active owner

Promotion is whoever-has-time — which means it mostly doesn't happen.

No PR cadence

Releases go out sporadically — not before, on, and after each open call and show.

"We notify the right sources every time we launch a call — because our own email can't be it. It's too weak or small." — Thursday Open Call meeting

THE APPROACH

Own The Engine, Plug In The Tools

We don't need to *adopt a PR platform*. We need a promotion engine — and we already own most of one. Extend what we have; rent only commodity inputs.

The engine we own (the spine)

- **Promotion repository** — extend the Artwork Archive Airtable (campaigns + open calls + submissions) with releases, playbook, contacts, partner registry, assets
- **Our own press-release generator** — reuse the AI content gen in the-intersect-curator / PolyWiz
- **n8n** — fires the playbook on every call

Plug-in tools (swappable)

- **PressRanger** — a journalist-DB feed + pitch radar we already own
- **Wires** — EIN / eReleases / PressRanger, per release
- **Listing boards & partners** — where we register calls

Same principle as Idea 009 — own the layer; don't rent your spine. If a tool's data or pricing changes, swap the feed, not the engine.

ONE TOOL WE ALREADY OWN

PressRanger — A Cheap, Already-Owned Feed

Scott and Juergen both bought **PressRanger** on an AppSumo lifetime deal — and forgot about it. Reminded, Scott's reaction: *"Happy to start leveraging it... given the low cost, it'd be interesting to turn it into a capability for artists or galleries."*

500K+

journalists

160K+

publishers / outlets

200K+

podcasts

\$0

our monthly cost

Juergen's account is **AppSumo Tier 3** — 10 brands, 4,000 contact exports/mo, pitch notifications, custom media rooms. Already enough to start.

THE KEY INSIGHT

It's Really Two Products In One Box

THE ASSET — WE OWN IT

Media database + CRM + AI

Find journalists & podcasts, draft releases and pitches with AI, track relationships, catch inbound press requests. **This lane costs \$3K–\$40K/yr elsewhere.**

A COMMODITY — PAY PER USE

Pay-per-release wire

\$299–\$399 to syndicate a release to 400–500 outlets. Useful, optional — and **not the bargain** (see next slide).

Mine the **software**. Shop the **wire** like any other line item.

WHAT THE SOFTWARE DOES

The Half That's Worth Our Time

Media databases

Search journalists, outlets & podcasts by beat, location, activity.

AI campaigns

Auto-builds a target list with fit scores; drafts releases & pitches.

Built-in CRM

Track Pitched → Replied → Published per campaign.

Pitch radar

Inbound press requests (HARO & more), scored for relevance.

Media room

A custom-domain newsroom per brand for our releases.

White-label

Brandable reports — the path to PR-as-a-service for our artists.

"IS IT ACTUALLY CHEAPER?"

The Software Is The Bargain — Not The Wire

SOFTWARE (WE PAY \$0)

TOOL	REAL COST / YR
PressRanger	\$0 — owned
Prowly	~\$3,100
Cision	~\$10K–15K
Meltwater	~\$15K–40K+

WIRE (PER RELEASE)

SERVICE	PRICE
EIN Presswire	~\$149
PressRanger	\$299 / \$399
eReleases	\$399+ (nonprofit)
PR Newswire	\$1,500–3,000

PressRanger's wire is **not discounted by our subscription** — anyone with a free account pays the same. It's mid-market, not cheap. Our savings are entirely in the **software** we already own.

DISTRIBUTION STRATEGY

Shop The Wire By The Story

Routine open call

Free listing boards + targeted pitches + paid social. **No paid wire**, or EIN Presswire (~\$149) for cheap SEO pickup.

Notable story

PressRanger Gold (\$399) when AI-chatbot indexing (AIWire) + podcast reach earns it.

Marquee moment

eReleases / CauseWire — real PR Newswire reach at nonprofit rates, for a flagship grant or partnership.

The database, CRM and pitching are the workhorse. The paid wire is the exception.

EYES OPEN

What PressRanger Isn't

Noisy data

Beats are matched by keyword on bios — arts lists carry false positives. One test: a 100-contact list exported with only ~8 direct emails.

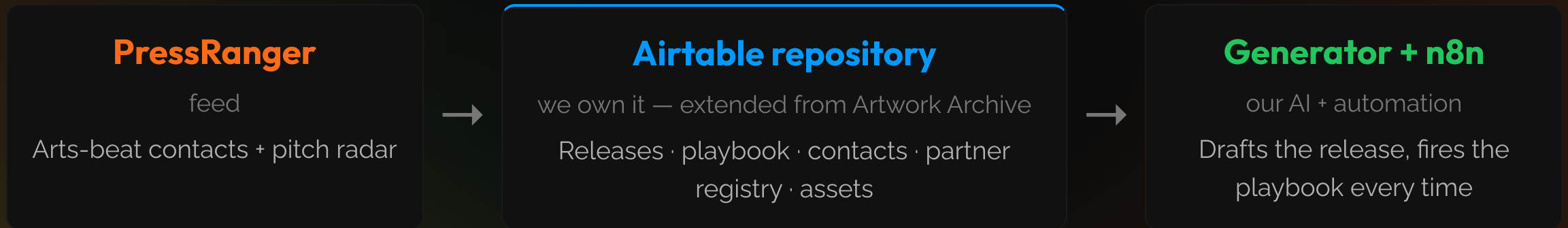
Send with care

Blasting cold email from the tool can hurt deliverability. Pitch small + personal from it; blast the artist list from our own ESP.

So: PressRanger for **discovery**, a curated Airtable as our **source-of-truth**, and disciplined sending — never "trust the raw list and hit send."

THE SYSTEM IN PRACTICE

Our Stack Is The Spine — PressRanger Feeds It



The "institutionalize the outreach" ask — but the spine is **ours**, not rented. Swap any feed without touching the engine.

WHERE TO REGISTER — US-WIDE

Most Of This Reach Is Free, And Unused

FREE LISTING BOARDS

EntryThingy
ArtCallEntry
Artwork Archive
ArtConnect
Fractured Atlas
+ CaFÉ for juried intake

ORGS & PARTNERS

NYFA Opportunities
Americans for the Arts
Artist Communities Alliance
Creative Capital list
State / regional councils
NEA — fund our program

AMPLIFIERS TO PITCH

Hyperallergic (tips@)
This Is Colossal
Create! Magazine
Art Opportunities Monthly
Booooooom
Arts to Hearts

Full directory with URLs, fees and contacts in [research/submission-platforms.md](#). We're not posting to most of these today.

THE PLAYBOOK

Same Steps, Every Call, Every Show

MOMENT	PRESS RELEASE	FREE LISTINGS	ARTIST EMAIL	PAID SOCIAL
Open call opens	✓	✓	✓	✓
Show announced	✓	—	✓	optional
Exhibition live	✓	—	✓	optional

The grant campaigns over-performed because we ran **Facebook ads to the landing pages** — not organic luck. Open calls deserve the same multi-channel treatment, pointed at one aligned registration URL with UTMs so we can measure it.

THE LEVER THAT MOVES NUMBERS

Paid Social, Automated Through PolyWiz

PR + listings + email harvest *existing* intent. Paid social **manufactures new intent** — and we already scoped the engine in Idea 007. Add one thin **"Open Calls" category** to it.

What it does

A new open-call record auto-generates 8–15 ad variants → **Meta + Pinterest** via Zernio, optimized for **submissions**, plus organic reminders trickled across the run (opened → 1 week left → 48h).

Why Pinterest

Visual-discovery, art-aligned audience, native lead ads, **CPC 30–50% under Meta**. Open calls are the use case that justifies turning it on.

Conservative budget

~\$150–\$300 per call (short flights, not always-on). First test: one brand, one call, ~\$250 — to measure cost-per-submission for the *first time*.

Compounds: submissions now + newsletter signups + a retargeting pool that makes the next call cheaper. Same engine repoints at donors in the fall.

PHASING

Start Small, Earn The Next Phase

PHASE 1 — NOW

Open-call promotion

Stand up Airtable, codify the playbook, run it live on [Art of Resistance](#). Owner: Elise.

PHASE 2 — FALL

Fundraising

Same engine, pointed at donors & impact press once the books / DAF groundwork lands.

PHASE 3 — OPTIONAL

PR-as-a-service

White-label the playbook for the artists & galleries in our network — Scott's instinct.

THE ASK

What We Need To Decide

- 1 **Reactivate access.** Scott is sharing the password with Elise & Juergen. Juergen's Tier 3 account is enough to start now.
- 2 **Elise evaluates it** against a real call — "can it find & help us reach arts journalists, podcasts and partners?" — not as an abstract tool review.
- 3 **Review as a team** on a Thursday — agree the playbook, the Airtable schema, and the first live test.



Short Version

We already own most of a promotion engine. **Extend the Artwork Archive** **Airtable** into a press-release + playbook system, build a small **generator**, plug **PressRanger in as one cheap feed**, and register every call across the free US-wide boards. Give Elise the wheel for one real open call — and we finally promote our calls instead of just running them.

Let's pick a call and try it. — Juergen Berkessel, Polymash

Sources & References

Evidence behind the claims in this deck

PressRanger features & databases (500K journalists / 160K publishers / 200K podcasts), CRM, AI, pitch radar, white-label — pressranger.com/pages/pr-software + journalist / publisher / podcast / pitch-request pages. First-party, retrieved 2026-06-12.

Distribution \$299 Premium / \$399 Gold, not subscription-gated, AIWire — PressRanger wholesale distribution & pricing.

EIN Presswire ~\$149/release; budget wires — einpresswire.com/pricing. eReleases \$399+ & nonprofit CauseWire — ereleases.com/causewire. PR Newswire real \$1,500–3,000 — Prezly PR Newswire pricing.

Cision ~\$10–15K/yr · Meltwater ~\$15–40K/yr · Prowly ~\$3,100/yr — Prowly; Prezly (estimates; custom-quote vendors).

Data-quality caveat (~8 emails on a 100-contact export; keyword categorization) — AppSumo reviews; Research.com.

US-wide listing boards, partners & amplifiers (EntryThingy, ArtCallEntry, Artwork Archive, ArtConnect, Fractured Atlas, NYFA, Americans for the Arts, Artist Communities Alliance, Creative Capital, Hyperallergic, This Is Colossal, Booooooom) — grounded Perplexity + WebSearch, 2026-06; URLs in the research file.

Full URLs, quotes, retrieval dates, account-confirmed Tier 3 capacity, and the meeting transcript: **research/sources.md** in the idea folder. Pricing was current June 2026 — verify before quoting.